

Course 25-26

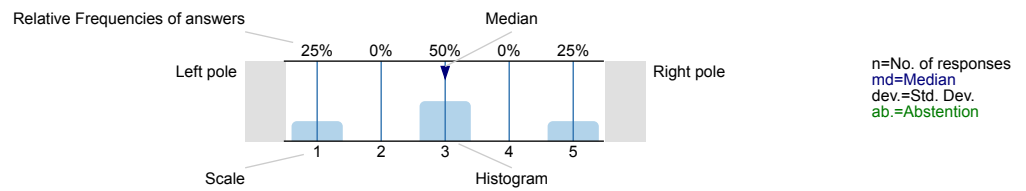
ENG5337 Advanced Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning 5 (ENG5337-1(25/26))
No. of responses = 12 (17.4%)



Survey Results

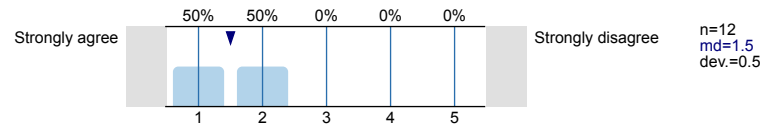
Legend

Question text

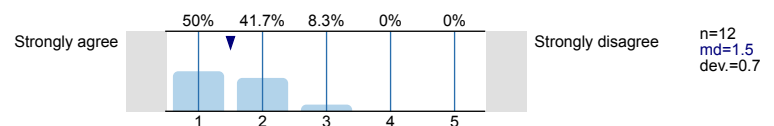


1. Teaching and course quality

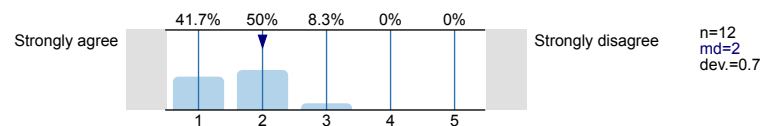
1.1) The lecturer explained things well



1.2) The course was intellectually stimulating



1.3) I am satisfied with the overall quality of the course



Profile

Subunit:

COSE: Engineering School Second Semester

Name of the instructor:

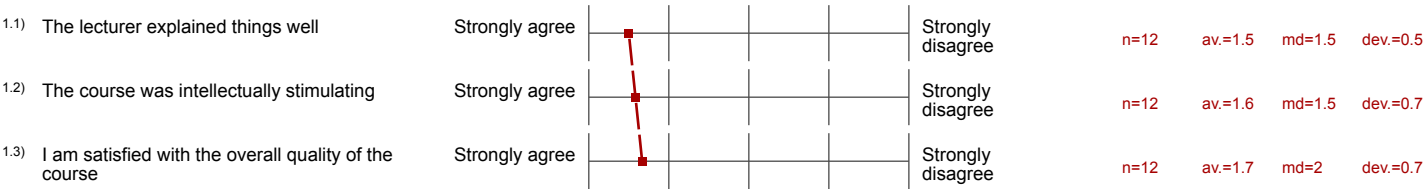
Course 25-26

Name of the course:
(Name of the survey)

ENG5337 Advanced Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning 5

Values used in the profile line: Mean

1. Teaching and course quality



Comments Report

2. Open Questions

2.1) What is good about this course?

- Assignments are well structured to cover everything that we learn during the lectures. Extra optional sessions.
- Interesting
- Khiem's lectures quality are pretty high, same as Katy's labs.
I pretty like Khiem tried to digest the knowledge by himself first, and then give the core concept directly to us, rather than just push everything that might be useful for us to understand by ourselves.
Katy's lab is also pretty useful when I want to do some experiment on my own. I really appreciate she provides us an environment about quanser and teach us using gymnasium, which is pretty advanced.
- Khiem is clearly incredibly passionate and knowledgeable. His section could and should be its own course. I felt horrible that he needed to fit so much into so little time. He is brilliant
- Lab parts
- Lecture and homework
- Quanser team coursework is so good
- Teachers are very patient
- The amount of hand on coursework and it's quality is really good and also the lecturer's way of explaining things is also good
- The course is good because it explains concepts clearly and includes practical tasks that make it easier to understand and apply what we learn.
- The course offers a strong and well-balanced learning experience. There is a good variety in teaching styles and lecture formats, which helps maintain engagement and supports different learning preferences. The lab sessions are well guided, and the support provided throughout the course is excellent. Whenever I had questions via email, I consistently received clear and timely responses.
Another positive aspect is the inclusion of external guest speakers working in the AI field. These sessions were both insightful and inspiring, providing a valuable perspective on how AI is applied in real-world industry settings.
The main lecturer of the course was particularly outstanding. She delivered most of the core material in an engaging and inspiring way and provided detailed, constructive feedback on coursework, which significantly supported learning and improvement.
The second lecturer was also very active and enthusiastic. He consistently ensured that students understood the material and often went beyond expectations by providing additional resources and even recording extra lectures for those interested in deeper learning.
- The lecturers are knowledgeable and explain the material very well. The written notes, example code and notebooks, and lecture slides are exceptional. Probably the best prepared material I have come across in my course so far. Assignments are generally well designed and interesting (with the possible exception of the group project). The additional sessions with industry were interesting and again feels like the lecturers going beyond what is usual for these modules.

2.2) How could this course be improved?

- Add more team coursework parts
- Despite its strengths, the course workload is quite heavy relative to its credit value. Although it is a 10-credit course, the amount of content and effort required is closer to that of a 20-credit course. The combination of lectures and lab sessions, along with the breadth of material covered, makes the course demanding.
The volume of content is particularly high, which can impact the depth of understanding. Instead of being able to fully master each topic, students may find themselves focusing on gaining a general understanding across many topics.
Reducing the content slightly or prioritizing key topics more clearly could help improve the learning experience. This would allow students to develop a deeper understanding without feeling overwhelmed and would better align the workload with the course credit level.
- Group work is unbearable given my classmates' lack of language and coding skills. I asked them what they thought of my proposed approach to the task, and they stared at me blankly and then said we should ask ChatGPT. Given their clear lack of coding skills, I took charge of that aspect and asked them to start making the presentation slides. I was told I should do the presentation as well as the coding because my English is better. That is unacceptable and an impossible situation to work in effectively. The university needs to address the language skills of the students it lets in, or stop assigning so much group work. This situation was not fair to me.
- Have more team courseworks
- Instead of group assignment working in pairs would be better.

- It's good for now
- I think its good enough
- More practice
- No
- Small issues: The industry session was interesting but there was a huge overrun (~30 mins I think). The CNN lectures regularly went overtime again by quite a lot. I found the more mathematical slides in the RL section quite difficult to read due to the font size.

Big Issue: The group project is exceptionally difficult given the level of english and understanding of the material in the class. No one in my group was able to explain their approach for the individual project or suggest an approach for the group project. Simple communication was extremely difficult. I felt I had to take on a huge amount of extra work in the group just to achieve a passable presentation. This is not just a problem with this module but has been an issue in almost every group project I have completed this year. I understand why lecturers want to do group projects but I just don't think they are really feasible given the english language skills in the current MSc cohort. They end up putting a huge burden on a small number of students and can cause a lot of stress. Particularly when almost every module has a group project and the same problems are happening multiple times across the year.

- The course could be improved by including hardware-based simulation tests in addition to software testing, so students can gain more practical, real-world experience.
- The RL concepts are quite hard to understand, and I find myself even harder to learn them by myself.

I guess this is because RL is a course that requires strong understanding of basic concepts, like the reward, state and action. Only when we understand those concepts can we understand Bellman equation. And only when we understand Bellman equation can we understand other algorithms. If I didn't understand reward, state and action, all the RL courses will look very daunting.

I can understand that this course tries to give us more advanced knowledge about latest RL algorithm, but I guess at least the course can use more time on emphasizing the importance of the basic concepts and Bellman equation. Only when we build a solid fundamental understanding can we explore the new knowledge.